www.tntextbooks.in

		**Ravenala madagascariensis* (traveller's palm), **Strelitzia reginae* (bird of paradise) and **Heliconia spp.*	Plant	Grown as ornamental plants

5.13.6 Monocot Family

Family: Liliaceae (Lily Family)

Systematic position

APG Classification		Bentham and Hooker Classification	
Kingdom	Plantae	Kingdom	Plantae
Clade	Angiosperms	Class	Monocotyledons
Clade	Monocots	Series	Coronarieae
Order	Liliales	Order	Liliales
Family	Liliaceae	Family	Liliaceae



Diagnostic Features

- Perennial herbs often with bulbous stem / rhizomes.
- Radical leaves.
- Perianth showy.
- Stamens six.
- Ovary superior.

Note: Liliaceae of Bentham and Hooker included *Allium, Gloriosa, Smilax, Asparagus, Scilla, Aloe, Dracaena* etc. Now under APG, it includes only ***Lilium*** and ***Tulipa***. All others are placed under different families.

General Characters

Distribution: Liliaceae are fairly large family comprising about 15 genera and 550 species. Members of this family are widely distributed over most part of the world.

Habit: Mostly perennial herbs persisting by means of a sympodial rhizome (*Polygonatum)*, by a bulb (*Lilium*) corm (*Colchicum*), shrubby or tree like (*Yucca* and *Dracaena*). Woody climbers, climbing with the help of stipular tendrils in *Smilax*. Trees in *Xanthorrhoea,* succulents in *Aloe*.

Root: Adventitious and fibrous, and typically contractile.

Stem: Stems usually bulbous, rhizomatous in some, aerial, erect (*Dracaena*) or climbing (*Smilax)* in *Ruscus* the ultimate branches are modified into phylloclades, In *Asparagus* stem is modified into cladodes and the leaves are reduced to scales.

Leaf: Leaves are radical (*Lilium*) or **cauline** (*Dracaena*), usually alternate, opposite (*Gloriosa*), sometimes fleshy and hollow, reduced to scales (*Ruscus* and *Asparagus*). The venation is parallel but